

FADE IN:

1 EXT. DRIVEWAY - NIGHT

RAIN pours outside. THUNDER claps.

Outside a suburban, two-storey house. PYTHAGORAS (70), a bearded old man in a chiton, stands at the end of the driveway.

Pythagoras is confused. He checks his watch, then realises he doesn't have one. He proceeds towards the house.

2 INT. GIRL'S ROOM - NIGHT

GIRL (17), a tired teenager, types on her Chromebook.

On-screen text reads "THE BIOLOGICAL APPROACH TO PSYCHOLOGY; POSSIBLE ERQS".

Suddenly a loud BANG! Girl peers out her window. It's only thunder. She calms down, continues typing.

Then a DING! Frustratedly, Girl gets up and storms out of the room.

The doorbell continues to ring as she makes her way over.

3 INT. HOUSE FRONT ENTRANCE - NIGHT

Girl peeks out the door's peephole, visibly worried.

Pythagoras is on the other end, magnified. Girl jumps back in surprise. She rubs her eyes and peeks again. The same scene greets her, except this time he waves.

Pythagoras begins gesticulating wildly with sign language.

Girl cracks open the door an INCH.

4 EXT. HOUSE FRONT ENTRANCE - NIGHT

Pythagoras waves again.

GIRL
What the fuck? What's this?

PYTHAGORAS
χαῖρε!

PILOT: THE CRIMINAL APPROACH TO PSYCHOLOGY

GIRL

Do you need... Help?

PYTHAGORAS

(Slightly dazed, out of it)
Garrulous men, like magpies, by
their continued loquacity
destroy the pleasures of
conversation.

Girl bites her lip worriedly. She is unsure whether she should bring out the taser or not.

GIRL

(Exasperated)
Okay, um -
Sorry dude, I'm gonna call some
friends. Maybe they can help you
out.

Girl retreats, forgetting to close the door behind her. Pythagoras is left waiting.

5 INT. DINING ROOM - NIGHT

Girl walks into the dining room hurriedly. She picks up her phone and begins to dial 911. Behind her, which she does not know about,

BEHIND

Pythagoras stands (entered off-camera).

OPERATOR's voice comes over the line.

OPERATOR

911, what's your emergency?

GIRL

(Scared out of her mind)
Hi. Yeah. I've got a bit of a
trespassing situation here.
There's this ancient-looking guy
standing around and he won't
leave.

OPERATOR

He's not inside the house, is
he? Are you in any immediate
danger?

GIRL

No, I locked the...
(Realisation dawns on her).

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Girl whips around to face Pythagoras. Benign as always, the old man cocks his head to the side. He points at the phone, then points at the floor.

This means 'put it down'.

Girl almost screams, paralyzed with horror, but clams up. She nods slowly and shakily.

GIRL

(To Operator)

Sorry, this was a prank. Don't come here. Bye!

Girl raises a hand to her mouth. Tears well up in her eyes.

GIRL

Please don't kill me.

Pythagoras softens.

PYTHAGORAS

(Poking at a bag of BREAD on the table)

Oh... Murder is not my intention, friend - I have been summoned here for reasons other than that.

GIRL

I don't wanna join whatever cult put you here. Get away from the bread.

Pythagoras leaves the bread, displaying startling obedience for a trespasser.

PYTHAGORAS

Sorry. We don't have,
(He reads the label),
Coconut rolls in Greece.

(Beat)

Anyway, I assure you with the utmost certainty that I am not part of a cult.

GIRL

I have a taser. In my drawer.

PYTHAGORAS

Telling me defeats the whole purpose, doesn't it?

PILOT: THE CRIMINAL APPROACH TO PSYCHOLOGY

Girl runs a hand through her hair. She's less suspicious than before; more exasperated.

GIRL

Well, y'know, I don't usually count on a fucking intruder coming into my home. Could you leave?

PYTHAGORAS

(Obviously hurt)
But you summoned me.

GIRL

No I didn't-

PYTHAGORAS (V.O.)

Yes you did.

CUT TO:

6 INT. GIRL'S ROOM - AFTERNOON

Girl lays on her bed, staring at the ceiling, as slow violin music plays.

The bedroom. It's tragic - various papers and pens are strewn about, nothing is tidy, and she seems sad.

PYTHAGORAS (V.O.)

Your life may not be terrible, but I sensed a... Certain need for guidance. I couldn't resist the plea.

CUT TO:

7 INT. GIRL'S ROOM - EARLY

The same room. But the clock on her dresser clearly displays "3:24 AM".

Girl screams into a pillow while MOTHER's knocking comes from the door.

MOTHER (O.S.)

What're you doing in there?

GIRL

(Muffled and teary)
Homework.

PILOT: THE CRIMINAL APPROACH TO PSYCHOLOGY

PYTHAGORAS (V.O.)

Pathetic.

CUT TO:

8 INT. GIRL'S BATHROOM - EARLY

A small, humble powder room with an ornate mirror above the sink. It's foggy and smudged.

Girl stares at her distorted reflection. She frowns, then starts making faces.

PYTHAGORAS (V.O.)

Your *soul* - your entire self -
is in disrepair.

(beat)

And I'm here to fix it.

Girl leaves the room, closing the door behind her. Slow violin music grinds to a halt.

CUT TO:

9 INT. DINING ROOM - NIGHT

GIRL

Doesn't really explain why
you're dressed in a Halloween
costume.

Girl's arms are crossed. She seems unimpressed and offended at his assumptions/preachiness.

PYTHAGORAS

It's *authentic*.

(awkward)

Also, what is Halloween?

After the initial confusion subsides, Girl's mouth parts like she's come upon a revelation. Her voice is kinder, softer.

GIRL

Ohh. Okay. Dementia.

PYTHAGORAS

(even more awkward)

Dear friend, I am slightly
unsure as to what "dementia" is...
But if that is how you brought
me into existence, then so be
it.

PILOT: THE CRIMINAL APPROACH TO PSYCHOLOGY

Girl grimaces. She ignores him, pulls out her phone, and searches for nearby senior homes.

Meanwhile, Pythagoras busies himself with the coconut rolls. They have a string tag attached - he can't figure this out for the life of him.

GIRL

(whispering, phone pressed
against ear)
Yeah. Hey, sorry for the short
notice, but I think one of yours
escaped?
(beat)
No, he's not violent.
(beat)
Yes, he's...

Girl rushes forward and snatches the bag away from him.

GIRL

He's in limited possession of
his faculties. Very vulnerable.

Pythagoras is the epitome of innocence. Puppy eyes and all.

GIRL

If non-violent, drive him over?!
Miss, don't you guys have some
kind of shuttle bus system for
these scenarios, or...

Uh huh. I need a name?

(turns to Pythagoras, points)

GIRL

Name.

PYTHAGORAS

Pythagoras.

Just when she thinks she can't get any more annoyed, she does.

GIRL

(covering speaker)
No - no you're not. I need a
proper name.

PYTHAGORAS

Πυθαγόρας ὁ Σάμιος.

GIRL

(back into speaker)

PILOT: THE CRIMINAL APPROACH TO PSYCHOLOGY

Um. He's an immigrant.

The lady on the other end of the call seems to be saying something important. Girl nods along, back turned to Pythagoras.

Pythagoras finds a pen on the dining room table. He then uses said pen to stab open the bag of coconut rolls.

SPLASH!

Ink explodes all over his robes and the table.

GIRL

Tomorrow morning at 8? I can do that. And his real name is what now...?

(beat)

Right. If that's the guy you think he is. Kay, bye.

A pause where Girl slowly turns back.

PYTHAGORAS

I am not the Guy. I am Pythagoras. I do not even *know* a Guy.

Pythagoras' voice rings with calm honesty, but Girl ignores that and only notices the mess he's made.

Carefully, he lifts an untainted coconut roll from the bag.

PYTHAGORAS

May I?

Cue the most horrified expression you've ever seen on Girl.

10 INT. LIVING ROOM - EARLY MORNING

Girl sits on the couch, barely awake. Her eyes are red-rimmed and watery; she hasn't slept at all. Pythagoras sits beside her, but not close by. He crinkles his coconut roll bag once, then twice, then thrice, then-

GIRL
Stop. Seriously.

Pythagoras stops crinkling the bag.

PYTHAGORAS
I am fascinated by this marvel
of human innovation.

GIRL
(Speaking to herself)
Schizophrenia doesn't run in the
family. He has a physical body-

Girl runs a hand through her hair and grimaces. She takes a deep, shaky breath, somewhat anxious.

GIRL
(To Pythagoras)
Uh.. As long as you're not
hostile, right?

PYTHAGORAS
The beginning of every
government starts with the
education of our youth.

GIRL
Oookay.

PYTHAGORAS
My turn. Where are your parents?

Girl rises. She walks to the KITCHEN out of scene.
Pythagoras, excited for breakfast, wiggles his legs.

GIRL
On a work trip for the week.
You're probably gonna have to..
Leave when they get back. Or
they'll put you in a funny
hospital. Cereal?

PYTHAGORAS
Yes, yes. I would like a glass
of plain corn flakes with no
milk.

10 INT. KITCHEN - EARLY MORNING

Girl pours milk into her cereal bowl, then some off-brand Fruity Pebbles. She carries it to the table with a spoon. She also prepares Pythagoras' request, rummaging through her cupboards to find corn flakes. The search ensues for a minute or so. There are none.

GIRL

No corn flakes. Oh, yeah. I don't know if you've heard, but there are so many cases where women die after letting men into their homes. I'm doing you a real big favour here.

No response from the other room.
Girl turns around.

PYTHAGORAS

No corn flakes?

GIRL

HOLY FUCK!

Pythagoras somehow arrives in silence. His footsteps don't make any noise, which concerns Girl a lot. She is definitely losing her mind.

GIRL

Why would you DO THAT!?

PYTHAGORAS

Sorry. I'm vegetarian.
(apologetically)

GIRL

...Okay?

Girl heads to the table and finds her seat. Pythagoras follows. In awkward silence, she eats her cereal and he stares. It's not a creepy stare, rather the stare of a curious toddler.

PYTHAGORAS

That looks edible.

GIRL

(beat)
Yeah. I'd hope so.

Another awkward silence ensues. Pythagoras clears his throat.

PILOT: THE CRIMINAL APPROACH TO PSYCHOLOGY

PYTHAGORAS

Are you satisfied with this
life?

GIRL

(pointing her spoon at him)
Weird question for...

Girl checks the clock.

GIRL

7:13 AM.

PYTHAGORAS

Are you satisfied, then?

Girl seems to seriously consider his question. She's
tired, it's the morning, and she can't bother getting mad
at him anymore. Slow weekend.

GIRL

Um, well, as satisfied as an IB
student can be before exam week.
Haha.

PYTHAGORAS

What's Ibay?

GIRL

School program thing. Like... High
school but with extra work.
(beat)
I can't be telling you all my
personal information.

PYTHAGORAS

Actually, I don't even know your
name!

Girl wolfs down mouthful after mouthful of cereal. While
doing this, she shakes her head vehemently.

GIRL

(still eating)
And you won't know it... Ever. If
we as peo-le, mmph, could get
whatever we wah-ed, like
entranshe into random peoples'
homefs...
(gulps)
That'd be nice. But we can't.

PILOT: THE CRIMINAL APPROACH TO PSYCHOLOGY

PYTHAGORAS

I *can*, though! Back in Greece, I
started a school and now
everyone listens to me.

GIRL

Well, that's- uhh- that's you.
We don't do that stuff here.

Pythagoras finds a CHOPSTICK on the table. He twirls it
deftly between his thumb and forefinger.

PYTHAGORAS

I'm not taking advice from
someone who cannot decide
whether they hate life or
tolerate it.

GIRL

Ouch. Says the home invader.

PYTHAGORAS

Says the logically fallacious!

GIRL

(groaning)
Just get out of my house-

PYTHAGORAS

Ineffective topic switch.
Earlier, I said I would repair
your soul, and I must remain
until that is seen through.
"Getting out" is not currently
possible.

Girl stares long and hard into her spoon. A distorted
face stares back, and she sighs. She doesn't speak for a
while.

GIRL

...Fine. Repair it, then. I can't
really turn down an offer to
talk.

PYTHAGORAS

Truly? Veritably?

GIRL

(checking the clock)
Uh huh. Maybe I'll learn a thing
or two before my Chem exam.

PYTHAGORAS

Ah, I knew you'd come along!
Yes!

PILOT: THE CRIMINAL APPROACH TO PSYCHOLOGY

Pythagoras nabs a NOTEBOOK from a neglected corner of the table. He leans back and pretends to write on it with his CHOPSTICK. Dumbfounded, Girl watches him do so.

PYTHAGORAS

Perfect, perfect, perfect. It's good to see that some children still appreciate their imaginary friends.
My good man Dante, oh, he told me about this little fellow from Texas who shot him-

GIRL

(realisation)
Pause. Imaginary... Friend?

PYTHAGORAS

Duh! I mean... Affirmative.
Correct one hundred percent.

GIRL

Christ, WHAT?
I thought you were a home invader! Like some campy Alzheimer's patient! I was just trying to buy time until the senior home picked you up.

Pythagoras traces some words with his CHOPSTICK; "Alzheimer's" and "home invader" in a loopy font.

GIRL

I mean, now that I'm thinking, I did have an imaginary friend in kindergarten. He was this old man, like, uhh...

Girl's head whips up and she gasps.
Now she gets it.

GIRL

No fucking WAY! Why didn't you tell me?

PYTHAGORAS

(smiling mischievously)
I am a devious fellow.

GIRL

Dude. If there's some kind of Imaginary Friend UN, call a meeting and tell them to fix your crazy.

PILOT: THE CRIMINAL APPROACH TO PSYCHOLOGY

PYTHAGORAS

YOUR crazy, you mean! I am a product of your imagination... But somewhat elevated. I am a ghost if ghosts were cool.

GIRL

You are not *cool*. You traumatised me last night.

Pythagoras traces a sad face onto the NOTEBOOK. Girl is palpably more relieved, but still worried - if he comes from her mind, then what other horrors lay within?

FADE IN:

11 EXT. PARK - AFTERNOON

The sky is blue. Girl and Pythagoras sit on opposite sides of a picnic bench. A SQUIRREL watches them from its dumpster. With a proper pen this time, Pythagoras writes as she speaks.

GIRL

So. I guess I could say I've been really stressed recently, 'cause of... Life.

Cut to Pythagoras, who is sketching the SQUIRREL instead of listening.

PYTHAGORAS

(nodding along)
Yes. I see. Life.

GIRL

And oh my God, it's just going to get worse from here on out. I want to do nothing. And everything at the same time.

PYTHAGORAS

Veeery twitchy tail, yes, yes.

GIRL

Are you listening to me?

Pythagoras' gaze is very obviously trained on the SQUIRREL. He draws its tail with a flourish.

PYTHAGORAS

...Sometimes.

PILOT: THE CRIMINAL APPROACH TO PSYCHOLOGY

Girl stands up, walks to the dumpster, and spooks the SQUIRREL. It runs away.

GIRL
(sitting down)
Are my problems not *interesting*?

PYTHAGORAS
No, they aren't particularly interesting. Look at my squirrel!

Ignoring any concept of personal space, Pythagoras shoves his NOTEBOOK in her face. Within lies a poorly drawn squirrel. A kindergartner could do better. Girl puckers, like she has eaten something sour, and waves it away.

GIRL
Stop. Get that- get that away.

PYTHAGORAS
(pouting)
Fine.

GIRL
Listen: If you don't get your act together... My parents are back from their trip in one week. I'm back from my 'sickness' in one week. Help me now or you'll be stuck in my closet for the rest of the school year.

PYTHAGORAS
The closet?! How cruel!

GIRL
Oh, I'll *do it*. Don't try me.

Pythagoras straightens. He fixes his beard, flicks an ant out of it, and nods.

PYTHAGORAS
My sincerest apologies for placing a squirrel above you. Let us begin, formally. Speak your piece and I shall write, then formulate a treatment plan.

Beat.

GIRL
Muuuch better!

PILOT: THE CRIMINAL APPROACH TO PSYCHOLOGY

Now, let's see. It all started
back in kindergarten...

FADE IN:

Cue a time-skip 1 min montage of Girl speaking (without audio, but with music) as the sky fades to sunset. Pythagoras gradually moves through the entire notebook. He is seen shaking his hand for cramps and forcing himself awake. In the meantime, Girl rants on - she shows no signs of stopping. Multiple squirrels pass by. The music stops abruptly.

SMASH CUT TO:

GIRL

Yeah, and now I'm here. In my
junior year of high school,
suffering all the same.

PYTHAGORAS

(half-conscious)
I see... I see...

GIRL

Got a treatment plan yet?

PYTHAGORAS

In all honesty, my friend, your
life both concerns and bores me.
This was the greatest test of
patience I have ever endured.

GIRL

You sound like my last
therapist. Maybe *I'm* the
problem.

Pythagoras rubs the sleep from his eyes.

PYTHAGORAS

You probably are. But I have the
solution!

GIRL

(pleasantly surprised)
Do you...?

PYTHAGORAS

A solution that I shall enact in
the morning.

And just like that, Pythagoras slumps over the picnic bench. Girl attempts to wake him, but he is steadfastly asleep. She groans and facepalms - her new trademark move - with a trace of amusement; a trace of *hope*.

Next Episode:
The Diagnostic Manual
of Mental Order